Lesson 11

Festivals of Bharat

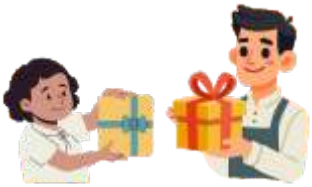
A9U4Q9

Let us do it

Reena has been travelling all around the country. In the capital city of Rajasthan, she saw all the houses were decorated. There were lights all around. People wore bright clothes. Gifts and sweets were being distributed among people. It looked like they were celebrating a festival. Reena was very happy, because she loves festivals. Like Reena, we all like festivals. Do your classmates love festivals?

Ask your friends which festivals they like. Do you know why they like them? Fill out the table with what you find!

Friend's name	Which festival does he/she like?



Let us read

During the trip, Reena made many new friends. Her friends were from different states, so they celebrated different festivals. Would you like to meet them?

1. Hello. My name is Rajshree. I am from Odisha. One of my favourite festivals is Raja Parba. We celebrate it for three days in the month of June. During the Parba, we pray to Bhumi devi (Earth Goddess) to give us good crops. We wear beautiful new dresses and ornaments. We put *alta* in our hands. We eat *pitha*. My favourite part of the festival is swings.

2. Hello. I am Rahul from Bihar. In my village, six days after Deepawali, we worship the Sun God and his sister Chhathi Maiyaa. This festival is called *Chhath pooja*. It is a very auspicious festival which is celebrated for three days. During Chhath, we fast, take holy baths and make thekuas and rice laddoos together.

Rajasthan also has many festivals. Which festivals can you remember? Discuss the names of these festivals with your class and teacher, explain how you celebrate festivals.

3. Hi, my name is Preeti. I am from Rajasthan. Do you see my new colourful lehenga? My mother gifted this to me. She is preparing for the festival of Gangaur. It is a sixteen day long festival. During Gangaur, women pray to Goddess Gauri, wife of Lord Shiva, to give them a prosperous married life. During this festival, we can see processions on the street. People make small idols of Shiva and Gauri. Women apply mehendi and everyone enjoys *ghewar*.

4. Hi, I am Manita. I am going to my home in Kerala to celebrate Vishu. Vishu is celebrated on April 14th every year. It is a traditional Malayali new year. On this auspicious occasion, people wear new clothes and they eat a feast called 'Sadhya'.

Let's Learn New Words

Find the sentences from the lesson that have the following words and write them in the given space.

Auspicious (adj): promising good luck

_____

Ornament (n): an object that is worn as jewellery

_____

Prepare (v): to make somebody/something ready

_____

Idol (n): a statue that people treat as a God

_____

Cousin (n): the child of your aunt or uncle

_____

Prosperous (adj): rich and successful

_____

Let us do it

(I) Select the correct option for the following questions -

(1) Which festival is celebrated in Odisha?
(a) Raja Parba (b) Chhath
(c) Bihu (d) Vishu

(2) What does auspicious mean?
(a) Bringing bad luck (b) Promising good luck
(c) A type of sweet (d) A festival decoration

(3) Which festival includes swings?
(a) Gangaur (b) Baisakhi
(c) Vishu (d) Raja Parba

(II) State whether the following statements are True or False -

(1) Gangaur is celebrated for 16 days. (True/False)

(2) Chhath is celebrated in Kerala. (True/False)

(III) Fill in the Blanks -

(1) During Chhath, people make _____ and _____

(2) Preeti wears _____ during Gangaur.

(IV) Answer the following questions -

(1) Why do women pray to Goddess Gauri during Gangaur?

(2) Which festival is celebrated in Kerala and why?

(V) Wow! So many festivals are celebrated in the country!
Name the ones you read in the chapter above.

_____ _____ _____

_____ _____ _____

(VI) Different foods are eaten during different festivals.
Read the festival name and write what special food is eaten during that festival.

Vishu : _____

Raja Parba : _____

Chhath : _____

Gangaur : _____

(VII) Now tell Reena about your favourite festival.

1. Why do we celebrate it?

_____

_____

2. How do we celebrate it?

_____

_____

3. What do you eat?

_____

_____

4. When do you celebrate the festival?

_____

_____

(VIII) Preeti said there are processions on the street during Gangaur festival. Do you know what is a procession? Let us find out from the dictionary.

Procession - _____

Have you seen a procession? Reena would love to hear from you:

Hello Reena,

I saw a procession _____.

In the procession, people _____.

There were _____.

I liked _____.

Chatter Champ

Festivals are marked with colours, celebrations and decoration. Songs are an important part of any festival. Do you know any popular song that is sung during your favourite festival. Ask the people around you what it means.

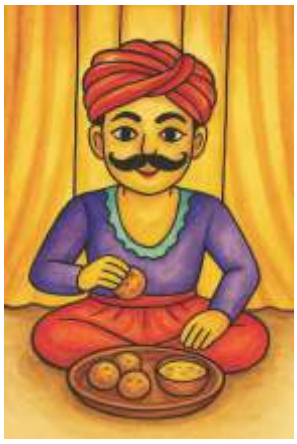
Song (You can write in your native language)	What does it mean?

Dhawal-Mayuri learn language

Read again the following questions -

a. Why do you celebrate it?
b. How do you celebrate the festival?
c. What special food do you eat during it?
d. When do you celebrate the festival?

Notice how these questions start - Words like 'what', 'which', 'how', 'why', 'when' denote that you want to ask something.
Dhawal has decided to travel like Reena. In his travel journal, he has pasted a lot of photos. Can you ask questions to find out more about his journey ?



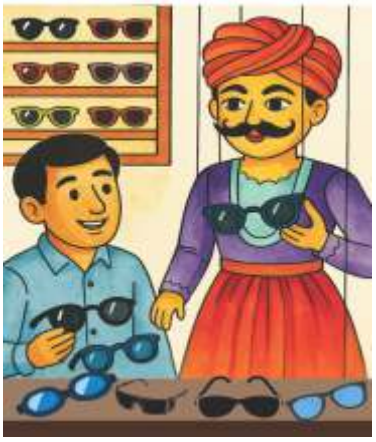
What are you eating?

Where _____ ?

Why_____ ?

When _____ ?

How _____ ?



_____ ?